

calling the Air 2 the ‘best tablet ever made’. The standout features being the much thinner bezels and huge drop in weight, the iPad Air for all practical purposes replaced the regular iPad lineup for a couple of years. It had two models, the Air in 2013 and the Air 2 in 2014 with only minor differences between the two – most notable of which is the inclusion of fingerprint scanning a.k.a. Touch ID as well as being thinner physically and the regular processor updates.

iPad Mini

A classic case of Apple making horribly disastrous predictions. Steve Jobs proclaimed 7 inch tablets were just too small to use. Cut to few years later, Apple found that one of their best selling iPad lines were going to be exactly that – the 7.9 inch iPad Minis. The first iPad mini released in 2012 basically just took the iPad 2 and shrunk it down to mini size. While people loved the portability that it offered, they were spoilt by retina displays and the Mini not having one was a sore point for many. When the Mini 2 was released in 2013, it quickly became a crowd favourite and sold like hot cakes. This is all good until Apple stuck a Touch ID scanner and called it the Mini 3. ‘We love to innovate’ indeed. The Mini line up didn’t get a major refresh until 2015 with the Mini 4, with an all new redesigned chassis that was thinner and taller than the Mini 2 and 3. There aren’t many differences between all the Mini models, with just a few upgrades and some tweaks here and there to deliver performance bumps, as they are meant for mobile, on the fly, light use.

iPad Pro

Apple’s attempt at a laptop replacement tablet, the iPad Pros are one of the most powerful tablets in the world, packing some serious processing power under a thin and light shell that can plow through most productivity tasks like number crunching in Excel with ease. The first iPad Pro was released in 2015 in an absolutely ginormous 12.9 inch screen size with a much more wield-able 9.7 inch version following in 2016. A year later the line was refreshed with plenty of upgrades and a switch from a 9.7 to a 10.5-inch screen size. The iPad Pro 2 is also the first tablet in the world to feature a 120hz refresh rate panel, making all animations buttery smooth. All iPad Pros share a couple of common traits, like the aforementioned souped up processing units. They also support Apple’s proprietary stylus – the Pencil – and have a special connector on the side called the Smart Connector for easily